

Service Support & Incident Management Policy

Document ID: IT-SVC-001 | Effective: June 27, 2026 | Version: 1.0 | Classification: Internal

APPROVED — ACTIVE

1. Purpose & Scope

This policy defines the support processes, service levels, incident response procedures, and operational continuity requirements for all enterprise technology services provided by the TechCorp IT Department. It establishes a single, consistent framework for how incidents are reported, triaged, escalated, resolved, and reviewed across every department and every service tier.

This policy applies to all IT support personnel, service desk agents, and operations engineers. It also applies to all TechCorp employees and contractors who report incidents or request support for any enterprise technology service, including the Enterprise AI Platform, business applications, endpoints, and infrastructure. It operates alongside the **Enterprise AI Platform Operations Policy (IT-OPS-001)** and each department's AI policy for service-specific incident definitions.

2. AI Platform Integration

The IT Department delivers support through a unified service management platform integrated with the Enterprise AI Platform's observability and automation suite, with incident coordination across the **Security Department** and the **AI Department**. Core support integrations include:

- AI-Powered Service Desk** — The Enterprise AI Platform serves as the first-line support agent for all departments, handling ticket creation, categorization, knowledge-base retrieval, and automated resolution for known issues, escalating to human IT agents when confidence falls below threshold or the user requests escalation.
- Intelligent Incident Correlation Engine** — AI-driven correlation of alerts, tickets, and platform telemetry to identify incident clusters and root-cause candidates, reducing mean time to resolution by surfacing related signals across the **Engineering Department's** services and **Security Department's** threat feeds.

- **Automated Major Incident Management** — When the AI monitoring suite declares a severity-1 or severity-2 incident, the platform automatically creates a war room channel, pages the on-call roster, assembles relevant telemetry dashboards, and begins drafting the stakeholder timeline updated continuously through resolution.
- **Service-Level Analytics Dashboard** — Real-time SLA tracking across all support queues with department-level views; AI predicts SLA breach risk and recommends load-balancing actions to the IT service desk manager.

Connected Departments: Security (security incident coordination & joint response) • Engineering (service ownership & technical escalation) • AI (AI service desk accuracy & incident correlation models) • Customer Support (ticket management process alignment) • Operations (business continuity impact assessment) • Legal (incident notification obligations & audit trail compliance)

3. Permitted Support & Incident Management Activities

Activity	AI Role	Human Oversight Required
Ticket intake & categorization	Automated creation, classification & routing	IT agent validates priority for all P1 and P2 tickets within 15 minutes
Knowledge-base article retrieval	Semantic search & resolution recommendation	Agent confirms resolution accuracy before closing; user confirms for self-service
Incident correlation & clustering	Cross-signal correlation & root-cause suggestion	Incident commander validates correlated view before actioning
Major incident war room assembly	Automated channel creation & stakeholder paging	Incident commander confirms participants and leads the response
SLA breach prediction & load balancing	Queue analysis & staffing recommendation	IT service desk manager approves load-balancing actions
Post-incident review drafting	Timeline assembly & contributing-factor analysis	Incident commander reviews, edits, and publishes the final report

4. Prohibited Activities

The following are strictly prohibited under this policy:

- **Closing a ticket without resolution confirmation.** Tickets may only be closed after the reported issue is resolved and the affected user or service owner confirms resolution. AI-suggested closures must be explicitly approved by a human agent.

- **Bypassing the incident severity matrix.** All incidents must be classified per the defined severity levels. Down-severitying an incident to avoid escalation, stakeholder notification, or SLA accountability is a policy violation reportable to IT leadership.
- **Operating without defined on-call coverage.** Every production service must have a published on-call rotation and escalation path registered in the incident management platform. Services without current on-call coverage may not deploy to production.
- **Suppressing or delaying a major incident declaration.** If an incident meets severity-1 or severity-2 criteria, it must be declared immediately. Waiting for confirmation, impact assessment, or convenient timing before declaring is prohibited.
- **Unapproved post-incident review modifications.** Post-incident review findings, including contributing factors and action items, are immutable once published. Changes require the incident commander's approval and a documented amendment.

5. Service Levels & Incident Severity Matrix

All support services must comply with TechCorp's **AI Safety Guidelines** (AI Department) and the **Data Protection Standards** (Security Department). Service levels and severity definitions include:

- **Severity 1 — Critical:** Complete platform outage or data loss affecting multiple departments. Response within 5 minutes, resolution or workaround within 1 hour. Stakeholder notification every 30 minutes until resolved.
- **Severity 2 — Major:** Core service degraded or single department fully blocked. Response within 15 minutes, resolution within 4 hours. Stakeholder notification hourly.
- **Severity 3 — Moderate:** Non-critical feature or single user blocked with workaround available. Response within 1 hour, resolution within 8 business hours.
- **Severity 4 — Minor:** Cosmetic issues, documentation errors, feature requests. Response within 4 hours, resolution within 5 business days.
- All response and resolution times are measured during business hours for severity 3 and 4; severity 1 and 2 are measured 24/7/365. Monthly SLA reports are generated by the Service-Level Analytics Dashboard and reviewed with department heads.

6. Support Quality Standards

IT support personnel must adhere to TechCorp's **Prompt Engineering Standards** when configuring AI service desk and incident management tooling. Support-specific

requirements include:

- AI service desk response prompts must be configured to match the support tier of the requesting department, with escalation sensitivity tuned per department's business criticality as defined by Operations.
- Incident correlation prompts must include service dependency maps maintained by Engineering and historical incident patterns for accurate clustering and root-cause suggestion.
- Post-incident review AI drafts must be based on the complete incident timeline, all chat transcripts, and all monitoring data from the incident window — prompts omitting any of these sources produce incomplete analyses.
- All support runbooks and knowledge-base articles must be version-controlled; AI-generated article drafts must be reviewed and approved by the IT service desk lead before publication to the knowledge base accessible to end users.
- Customer satisfaction surveys are triggered automatically on ticket closure; aggregate CSAT scores below 85% trigger a service desk quality review within 30 days.

7. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
VP of IT	Overall service support ownership; SLA accountability; major incident escalation authority; post-incident review approval for severity-1 incidents.
IT Service Desk Manager	Day-to-day support operations; agent scheduling and on-call coverage; SLA monitoring and breach response; knowledge-base governance; CSAT quality reviews.
IT Support Agents	Ticket triage, resolution, and escalation; knowledge-base usage and contribution; incident severity classification; user communication throughout ticket lifecycle.
Incident Commander (rotating)	Major incident response leadership; war room facilitation; stakeholder communication; timeline maintenance; post-incident review ownership.
Engineering Department	Service-specific on-call coverage; technical escalation for application-level incidents; service dependency map maintenance; incident resolution code deployment.
Security Department	Security incident coordination; joint incident command for security-related events; threat intelligence input to incident correlation; security incident post-review.
AI Department	AI service desk model performance; incident correlation engine accuracy; automated resolution confidence monitoring; AI support tool prompt governance.
Operations Department	Business impact assessment during major incidents; business continuity plan activation; department communication coordination with IT during

	service disruptions.
Legal Department	Incident notification obligation determination; regulatory reporting timeline compliance; post-incident legal review for incidents with external impact.

8. Incident Response

The IT Department leads incident response for all technology service incidents, coordinating with specialized response teams for security and AI-specific incidents. Incident response lifecycle:

- **Detection** — AI monitoring or user report triggers incident creation. All monitoring alerts are automatically logged as incidents in the service management platform.
- **Classification** — Severity assigned per the severity matrix. AI suggests severity based on impact signals; the responding IT agent confirms within the response SLA for the assigned severity.
- **Escalation** — If the incident is not resolved within 50% of the resolution SLA, automated escalation to the next support tier triggers; severity-1 and severity-2 incidents auto-escalate to the incident commander immediately.
- **Resolution** — Service restored and verified by the affected user or service owner. Workaround documented if full resolution is deferred; deferred resolution generates a linked problem ticket tracked by Engineering.
- **Post-Incident Review** — Mandatory for severity-1 and severity-2 within 5 business days; optional for severity-3 at the incident commander's discretion. Reviews are blameless, focused on process and system improvement, with action items tracked to completion in the platform.
- **Closure** — Incident closed after resolution verified, post-incident review completed (if required), and action items registered. Closure is confirmed by the incident commander for severity-1 and severity-2.

Operational continuity during major incidents is governed by the business continuity plans maintained by Operations. IT maintains the technical disaster recovery procedures tested quarterly per the Enterprise AI Platform Operations Policy.

9. Training & Compliance

- All IT support agents must complete the IT Service Management & Incident Response certification within 60 days of onboarding and recertify annually.
- Incident commanders must complete the Major Incident Management & Crisis Communication workshop before being added to the commander rotation.
- All Engineering personnel participating in on-call rotations must complete the On-Call Response & Escalation training covering incident classification, war room procedures, and handoff protocols.

- Quarterly incident management exercises are conducted by IT with participation from Security, Engineering, and Operations; exercise findings are incorporated into the continuous improvement backlog.
- Monthly SLA performance and CSAT reports are reviewed by the IT Service Desk Manager with the VP of IT; persistent SLA breaches trigger a service improvement plan with defined remediation milestones.

10. Review & Revision

This policy is reviewed every 6 months by the VP of IT, IT Service Desk Manager, and lead incident commander, with input from the Security Department (for security incident coordination procedures), Engineering Department (for service ownership and on-call practices), AI Department (for AI service desk and correlation engine performance), Operations Department (for business continuity alignment), and Legal Department (for incident notification and regulatory compliance). Revisions are versioned, approved by the VP of IT, and synchronized with updates to the Enterprise AI Platform Operations Policy, the Security Incident Response Plan, and department-level AI policies. Emergency revisions triggered by major incident findings follow an accelerated 14-day review cycle.

Referenced Policies: Enterprise AI Platform Operations Policy (IT-OPS-001) • Identity, Access & Provisioning Policy (IT-IAM-001) • Enterprise Systems Integration Policy (IT-INT-001) • AI Safety Guidelines (AI Department) • Prompt Engineering Standards (AI Department) • Data Protection Standards (Security Department) • Security Incident Response Plan (Security Department)